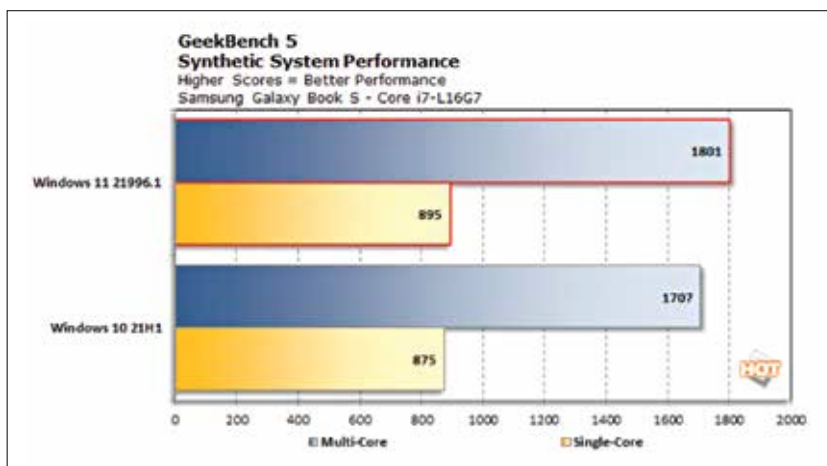


Source: HotHardware

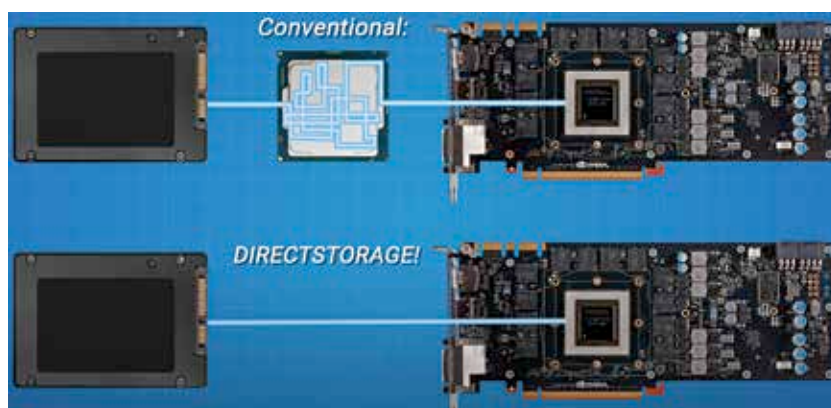


GeekBench scores showing the CPU performance improvements in Windows 11

on gamers. The most significant was the announcement of Auto HDR support coming to Windows in this this version. Microsoft has already seen benefit from doing this with its latest console, so the engineers in its Windows division have offered gamers the exact same experience, if not better! According to Microsoft, “Games will look better than ever thanks to Auto HDR, a unique capability we’re offering with Windows 11 which automatically adds High Dynamic Range (HDR) enhancements to games built on DirectX 11 or higher that previously only leveraged Standard Dynamic Range (SDR). HDR allows a supported game to render a much wider range of brightness values and colours, giving an extra sense of richness and depth to the image.” It would be interesting to see how it affects real-world performance, once the games start to come in and Windows 11 becomes mainstream.

DIRECTSTORAGE

What is DirectStorage? It is another technology that made its debut on consoles and is now finding its way



Source: Techquickie on YouTube

Here’s what the difference between systems lacking and having DirectStorage

into the world of PC gaming. One of the worst things about being a gamer is waiting for levels to load, and this often happens because the already overloaded CPU is bottle-necking the system by also acting as the hard

drive controller. Instead, DirectStorage works by establishing a direct communication line, between the storage device of your computer and the GPU, helping the game data load faster. Much faster!

There are a few things to be noted here. Firstly, only computer systems that are “DirectStorage optimized” will be able to enjoy this innovation – this means having an NVME SSD that games are stored on, using the “Standard NVM Express Controller” driver and a DirectX12 GPU with Shader Model 6.0 support.” In terms of GPU, you need an RTX 2000 or 3000 series from NVIDIA, or a RDNA 2 line GPU from AMD.

Windows 10 will not be getting this update, so the loyalists of the current version of Windows will

have to update their systems to Windows 11, if they want to enjoy DirectStorage.

XBOX APP

Microsoft also announced that with Windows 11, the Xbox app will be an out of the box feature and will be baked directly into the operating system. Using this, along with the already popular Xbox Game Pass, Microsoft is hoping to blur the lines between console and PC gaming, and bringing cross platform gaming into the mainstream.

Earlier in June, Microsoft had announced that a number of new games would be coming to Game Pass, including the likes of *Halo Infinite*, *Twelve Minutes*, and *Age of Empires IV* which are set to release this year.

Source: IGN



Auto HDR is all set to be a visual treat for gamers